

fasting:

- ↳ Third most important ritual after Prayer and Zakat.
- ↳ The Arabic word for it is 'sawm' which means 'to give up something'.
- ↳ While fasting, a person gives up things that are normally allowed like food, drink, physical needs just because God has commanded it. This shows willingness to follow his commands above all else.
- ↳ It is made obligatory for believers to help them become mindful of Allah.
- ↳ Fasting is for a set period of time.
- ↳ Exceptions for those who are ill, travelling but they are required to make for it by fasting the missed days later or feed a needy if they are capable.
 - ↳ More important they do this so they don't miss out on blessings of Ramadan.
- ↳ The month of Ramadan is significant because Quran was revealed providing guidance for humanity.
- ↳ The allowances for not fasting reflect Allah's desire to make things easier.
- ↳ Fasting helps believers glorify God and express gratitude to him.

Objective of fasting:

- ↳ To be mindful of Allah.
- ↳ Fasting reminds man he is Allah's servant. These feelings are enhanced when natural desires of the body are given up.
- ↳ When this ritual is observed vigilantly every year, then the fact he is servant of Allah is ingrained in his instincts and influences how they live their lives.
- ↳ Secondly, fasting helps a person truly appreciate that one day he will be held accountable before Allah. When hunger, thirst & physical desires make the day challenging, it is the awareness of being accountable before God that prevents a person from giving into these desires.
- ↳ Thirdly, fasting helps cultivating patience, which is essential for taqwa. This patience allows a person to develop qualities like honesty, justice, perseverance.

↳ A person must avoid wrongdoings to get blessings of fasting. Some are:

1. Making Ramadan a month of savouring taste buds.
2. People make hunger and thirst an excuse to get angry.

The Prophet (sws) is reported to have said: "The fast is a shield; whoever among you fasts should not indulge in vulgar talk nor be overcome by his emotions; then if anyone abuses him or initiates a fight he should respond by saying: 'I am fasting, my brother, I am fasting.'" (Al Bukhari)

3. Finding replacement for food & drinks like playing cards, reading novels, listening songs, watching movies, gossiping & back biting thinking this doesn't ~~there~~ break fast.
4. Fasting not for God but to protect from other's criticism.